



Support
their learning.

Understand
their world.

Empower
their future.



The

Information Guide

FOR PARENTS — 

A PRACTICAL GUIDE TO SUPPORT YOUR CHILD'S LEARNING JOURNEY

Every child learns in their own unique way. Understanding how they learn best helps you support their confidence, improve their motivation and guide them towards success – at school and in life.



UNDERSTAND

Learn about different learning styles and what they mean for your child.



SUPPORT

Discover practical ways to support learning at home and at school.



GUIDE

Help your child set goals, plan and stay organised with confidence.



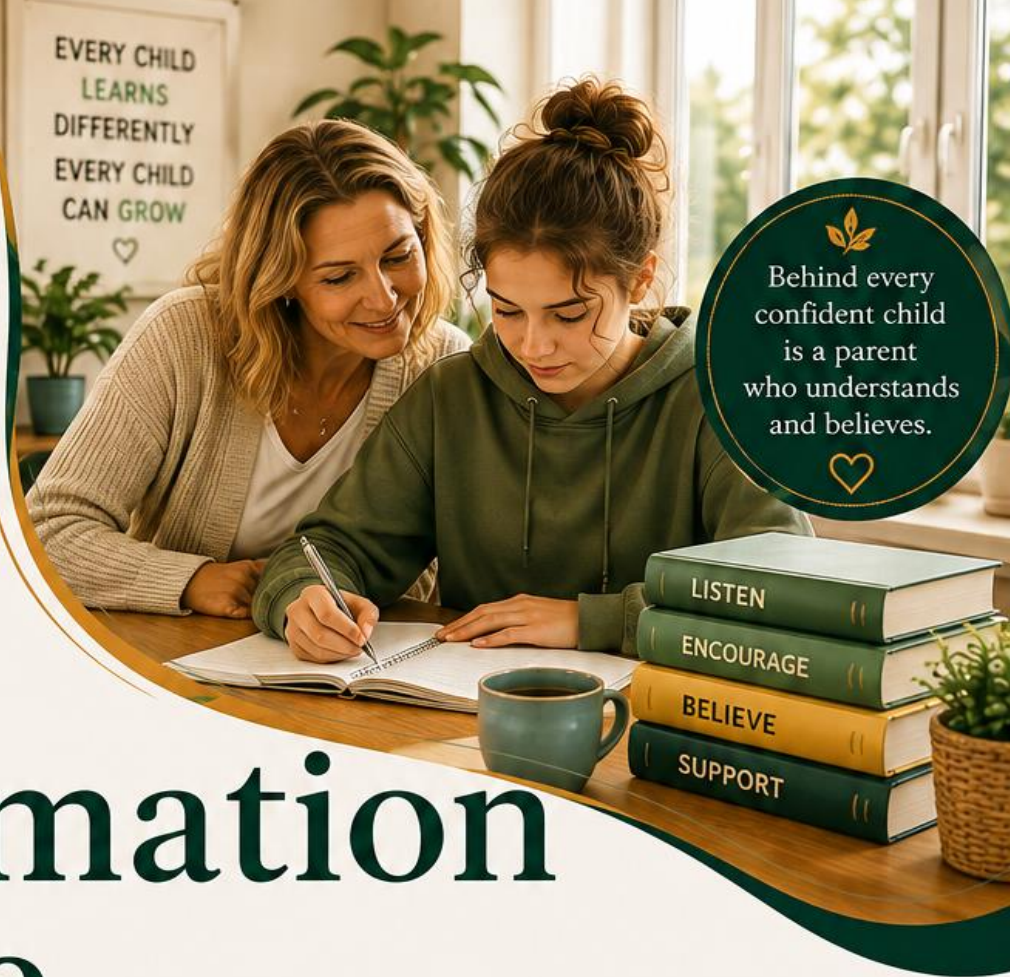
EMPOWER

Build self-belief, resilience and a positive mindset for lifelong success.



GROW TOGETHER

Strengthen your relationship and celebrate progress every step of the way.



Behind every
confident child
is a parent
who understands
and believes.



Angela's Insight

When parents understand how their child learns, everything changes. You stop comparing. You start connecting. You become their biggest cheerleader and their safest place. **Your support today builds their confidence for tomorrow.**



MORE THAN POINTS

Coaching for Life Beyond the Points



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UNDERSTAND. SUPPORT. EMPOWER. ACHIEVE.





CHAPTER 1

The Changing World of Education

WHY LOOKING BEYOND THE CAO MATTERS

When many of us were in school, the pathway ahead often felt simple: work hard, get good points, go to university and build a career. That route worked for many people and it still does.

But today's world is very different. New industries are emerging, technology is transforming the way we work and the skills employers need are constantly evolving.

There are now more opportunities than ever before – and not all of them begin with a traditional degree.

The CAO is just one option among many. Apprenticeships, PLC courses, traineeships, work experience, further training and direct employment can all lead to rewarding and successful careers.

What matters most is finding the pathway that suits your teenager's strengths, interests and goals – not simply following the path that others expect.

Because the most successful journeys are the ones that reflect who your child really is.

“

“The future belongs to those who believe in the beauty of their dreams.”



ELEANOR ROOSEVELT



Angela's Insight

Many parents worry that if their teenager doesn't go to university, they will miss out on a successful future. The truth is, there are many ways to build a fulfilling life.

My role is to help families see all the possibilities – and find the one that feels right for them.





CHAPTER 2

Explore the Many Pathways

UNDERSTANDING THE OPTIONS AFTER SCHOOL

For many years, university was seen as the natural next step after school. Today, however, there are many respected routes that can lead to rewarding careers, financial security and personal fulfilment.

Every young person is different. Some thrive in academic environments, while others flourish through practical experience, workplace learning or creative enterprise.

The most successful pathway is not the one everyone else chooses—it's the one that matches your teenager's strengths, interests, learning style and aspirations.

“

Success is not about following the same path as everyone else. It is about discovering the path that allows you to become the best version of yourself.



COMPARE THE MAIN PATHWAYS

PATHWAY	TYPICAL DURATION	COST	EARN WHILE LEARNING	BEST SUITED TO
 University	3–4 years	Higher	⊗	Academic learners and professional careers
 PLC Course	1–2 years	Low	⊗	Exploring interests or progressing to university
 Apprenticeship	2–4 years	No tuition	✓	Practical, hands-on learners
 Traineeship	6–20 months	Usually free	Sometimes	Building workplace skills
 Employment	Immediate	None	✓	Those ready to begin work
 Entrepreneurship	Ongoing	Varies	Depends	Creative and independent thinkers

THINGS EVERY PARENT SHOULD KNOW



There is no single “right” pathway.



Every pathway offers opportunities to progress.



Many careers can be reached through more than one route.



Young people often change direction as they discover their interests and strengths.



Success is built through continuous learning—not simply by the qualification someone starts with.



Angela's Insight

One of the greatest gifts we can give our children is the freedom to explore possibilities. I've worked with students who have found incredible success through university, apprenticeships, PLC courses and employment. Once teenagers understand that there is more than one route to achieving their goals, they begin making choices with confidence instead of fear.



**TRAINEESHIP****HEALTHCARE****ENTREPRENEURSHIP**

Which Pathway Could Be Right for Your Teenager?

Rather than asking "Which pathway is best?", ask:

"WHICH PATHWAY BEST SUITS MY TEENAGER?"



UNIVERSITY

Ideal for students who enjoy academic learning and are working towards careers that require a degree.

Typical duration: 3–4 years

Can lead to: Teaching, Nursing, Engineering, Business, Law, Science and many other professions.



PLC COURSES

Excellent for students who benefit from practical learning, smaller class sizes or wish to progress to higher education through an alternative route.

Typical duration: 1–2 years

Can lead to: Employment, Higher Education or specialised qualifications.



APPRENTICESHIPS

Perfect for students who enjoy learning by doing.

Typical duration: 2–4 years

Benefits: Earn a salary while gaining recognised qualifications and valuable workplace experience.



TRAINEESHIPS

Shorter industry-focused programmes combining classroom learning with work placements to develop practical skills and confidence.

Typical duration: 6–20 months



EMPLOYMENT

Starting work straight after school allows young people to gain experience, develop independence and often discover career interests before returning to education later.



ENTREPRENEURSHIP

An exciting pathway for creative, motivated young people who enjoy solving problems, developing ideas and creating opportunities for themselves and others.

REMEMBER...



A first decision does not have to be a final decision.

Many successful careers include pathways such as:



PLC → University



Apprenticeship → Degree



Employment → College



University → Business



Traineeship → Employment

Today's education system allows young people to continue learning, retrain and change direction throughout their lives.

QUESTIONS TO DISCUSS TOGETHER



What type of learning does my teenager enjoy most?



Would they prefer practical experience or classroom learning?



Are they motivated by earning while learning?



Which environment allows them to feel confident and successful?



What pathway best reflects their strengths and interests—not someone else's expectations?



Angela's Insight

Choosing a pathway isn't about predicting your child's entire future. It's about helping them take the next step with confidence. Careers evolve, opportunities change and new doors continue to open throughout life. The most important decision is simply choosing the next step that feels right for them.



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Good intentions
come from love.
Awareness creates
a better path
forward.

CHAPTER 3

Common Mistakes Parents Make

AVOIDING PRESSURE, PROTECTING CONNECTION

Every parent wants the best for their teenager. But even with the best intentions, it's easy to fall into patterns that create pressure, stress or distance without realising it.

Awareness is the first step. When we understand what can hold our teenagers back, we can choose a different approach—one that builds confidence, trust and a stronger connection.

Here are some common mistakes parents make—and what to do instead.



1

PUSHING THEIR OWN DREAMS

When we project our own hopes onto our teenagers, they can feel misunderstood and pressured.

INSTEAD: Encourage them to discover their own strengths and interests.



2

COMPARING THEM TO OTHERS

Comparisons damage confidence and make teenagers feel like they're not enough.

INSTEAD: Focus on their progress, not someone else's.



3

FOCUSING ONLY ON GRADES

While important, grades don't define their future or their worth.

INSTEAD: Celebrate effort, improvement and personal growth.



4

RUSHING THEIR DECISIONS

Making big decisions too early can lead to fear and regret.

INSTEAD: Give them time, information and space to explore.



5

NOT LISTENING ENOUGH

When teenagers don't feel heard, they stop sharing.

INSTEAD: Listen without interrupting and show genuine interest.



6

FORGETTING TO SHOW BELIEF

Teens need to know we believe in them, especially when they doubt themselves.

INSTEAD: Remind them of their strengths and the times they've succeeded.

“

*It's not about
having all the
answers. It's about
helping your
teenager believe
they can find
their own.”*



ANGELA O'SULLIVAN



Angela's Insight

No parent gets it right all the time—and that's okay. The goal isn't perfection. It's connection, awareness and a willingness to learn together.

When we let go of pressure and focus on support, our teenagers feel safer, stronger and more confident to follow their own path.

Small changes in how we show up can make the biggest difference.





CHAPTER 4

Communication Makes a Difference

HOW TO HAVE CONVERSATIONS THAT HELP, NOT HINDER

Talking about the future can feel daunting for both parents and teenagers. It's easy for conversations to turn into debates or place pressure on your teenager to have all the answers.

The goal isn't to push them towards a particular path – it's to create a supportive space where they feel comfortable exploring their options.

Start by listening. Ask open questions. Show genuine interest in their thoughts, ideas and concerns.

Avoid jumping in with your own solutions. Instead, guide them to think about what matters to them.

When teenagers feel heard, they are more likely to open up, build confidence and make decisions that reflect who they truly are.

The questions you ask today can help your teenager make confident decisions for tomorrow.



QUESTIONS TO ASK YOUR TEENAGER

Instead of offering advice, try asking questions that encourage your teenager to think, reflect and explore.



What kind of work do you think you would genuinely enjoy?



When do you feel most confident and capable?



What subjects or activities do you look forward to most?



Would you rather learn by studying, by doing, or a mixture of both?



What worries you most about life after school?



How can I best support you as you make these decisions?

“

The most important thing in communication is hearing what isn't said.”



PETER DRUCKER



Angela's Insight

The best conversations happen when we create space for our teenagers to share their thoughts without fear of judgement.

You might not always agree with their ideas – and that's okay.

Your role is to listen, support and help them explore the possibilities, not to choose for them.



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CHAPTER 5

Breaking the Myths That Hold Us Back

LET'S LEAVE OLD BELIEFS BEHIND

Many of the decisions we make for our teenagers are shaped by beliefs we grew up with.

Some of those beliefs were helpful in the past – but today they can limit our children's choices and create unnecessary pressure.

By letting go of outdated myths, we can open the door to new possibilities and help our teenagers build futures that are right for them.

Here are some common myths – and the truth behind them:



Myth: University is the only path to success.

Truth: There are many respected, rewarding careers that don't require a degree.



Myth: Good points are everything.

Truth: Confidence, skills and experience matter just as much to employers.



Myth: Apprenticeships are only for academic underachievers.

Truth: Apprenticeships build real skills, earn while you learn and lead to excellent careers.



Myth: Once you choose a path, you're stuck.

Truth: People change direction all the time – it's a sign of growth, not failure.



Myth: Everyone else knows what they're doing.

Truth: Many young people feel unsure – you're not alone.

When we challenge these myths, we give our teenagers the freedom to explore, discover and create their own path.

“

Sometimes the biggest thing we can do for our children is to stop living our dreams through them – and start believing in theirs.”



STEVE MARABOLI



Angela's Insight

Old myths can keep us feeling stuck. New possibilities begin the moment we choose to see our teenagers for who they are – not who we thought they should be.

Believe in their potential, not your expectations.





Skills & Strengths

Interests & Passions

Values & Purpose

Opportunities

Your Path ♥



CHAPTER 6

Supporting Your Teen Without Pushing

THE POWER OF ENCOURAGEMENT AND TRUST

As parents, it's natural to want the best for our children. We want to guide them, protect them from mistakes and help them make the right decisions.

But when it comes to choosing a pathway after school, too much pressure can have the opposite effect.

Teenagers need space to explore, make choices and learn from the process – with your support, not your expectations.

How to support without pushing:

-  **Encourage, don't pressure.**
Let them know you believe in them no matter what path they choose.
-  **Ask, don't assume.**
Ask questions to understand their interests, worries and dreams.
-  **Listen with an open mind.**
Avoid judgement and show respect for their ideas, even if they're different from yours.
-  **Focus on strengths, not weaknesses.**
Help them recognise what they're good at and what they enjoy.
-  **Build their confidence.**
Remind them that setbacks are part of the journey.
-  **Be their safe space.**
Let them know they can come to you, without fear of criticism.

**When we support with trust and understanding,
our teenagers gain the confidence to follow their own path.**

“

“A teenager who feels supported will always go further than one who feels pushed.”



UNKNOWN



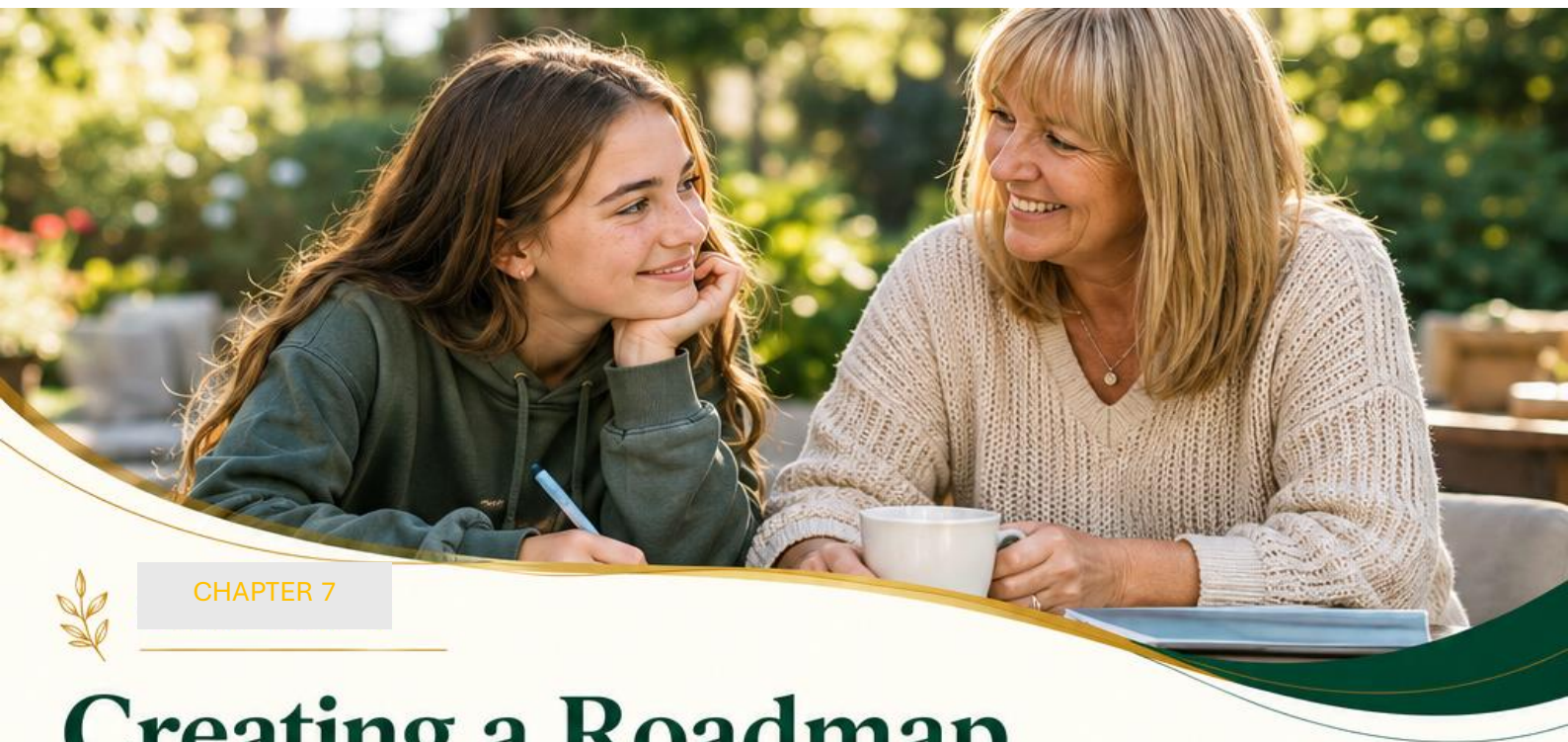
Angela's Insight

The most valuable thing we can give our teenagers is not the perfect plan – it's the confidence to believe in themselves.

Your support helps them feel safe to explore, make decisions and create a future that feels right for them.

You don't have to have all the answers – you just have to be their biggest cheerleader.





CHAPTER 7

Creating a Roadmap for Your Teen's Future

TURNING IDEAS INTO ACTION WITH CONFIDENCE

Once your teen has explored their interests, strengths and pathways, the next step is to put it all together and create a clear, practical plan for their future.

A roadmap gives them focus, motivation and the confidence to take the next steps – knowing they are working towards a future that truly suits them.

This isn't about rushing them into a decision, but about helping them see the possibilities, build a plan and feel supported as they move towards their goals.

KEY STEPS IN CREATING A ROADMAP

- 1 Reflect on Their Goals**
Help your teen clarify what they want for their future – work, study or a combination.
- 2 Explore Their Options**
Research different pathways and opportunities, from university and apprenticeships to enterprise and creative careers.
- 3 Set Short, Medium and Long-Term Goals**
Break the journey into smaller steps so it feels achievable.
- 4 Take Action**
Create a plan together with clear next steps, dates and resources for support.
- 5 Review and Adjust**
Life changes and interests evolve – keep the plan flexible and open to new opportunities.

“

“A good roadmap doesn't limit your teen's choices – it helps them see where they can go and how to get there.”



ANGELA O'SULLIVAN



Angela's Insight

When your teen has a clear roadmap, they feel more in control, more motivated and much more confident in their decisions. It's about giving them the space to dream, the tools to plan and the encouragement to take action – at their own pace.

Your support can make all the difference in turning their potential into reality.





CHAPTER 8

Working With a Coach

WHY SUPPORT AND GUIDANCE CAN CHANGE EVERYTHING

Making decisions about the future can feel overwhelming for teenagers. There are so many options, so much information and so much pressure to get it “right”.

A coach provides a safe, supportive space where your teen can explore their strengths, identify what matters to them and create a plan for the future that feels right.

Coaching isn't about telling them what to do – it's about empowering them to discover their own answers.

How coaching can help your teenager:

-  **Gain clarity.**
Understand their options and what aligns with their strengths, interests and values.
-  **Build confidence.**
Feel more self-assured about their abilities and future choices.
-  **Set meaningful goals.**
Create realistic, inspiring goals that give direction and purpose.
-  **Make informed decisions.**
Explore all pathways and pick the one that's right for them, not someone else.
-  **Overcome obstacles.**
Develop resilience and problem-solving skills to handle challenges.
-  **Feel supported every step of the way.**
Know they have someone in their corner who listens and believes in them.

With the right support, your teenager can move forward with confidence, clarity and excitement for their future.

“

“A coach doesn't walk the path for you. They walk beside you, helping you discover the path that's right for you.”



UNKNOWN



Angela's Insight

Sometimes teenagers just need space to think, someone to listen and the right questions to help them see what's possible. Coaching can be the turning point that helps them step into their future with confidence and purpose.

You don't have to have all the answers – a coach can help them find theirs.



Ready to Discover Your Potential?

 Every young person deserves the chance to understand how they learn, where their strengths lie and what pathway is right for them.

At **More Than Points**, I work with teenagers and parents to build confidence, identify strengths and create a future that is based on potential—**not pressure.**



Whether you're feeling overwhelmed by subject choices, unsure about career options or simply looking for clarity, **coaching can help you move forward with confidence.**

I CAN HELP YOU WITH:

- ✓ Discovering your learning style
- ✓ Identifying your unique strengths
- ✓ Career and pathway exploration
- ✓ College, PLC and apprenticeship guidance
- ✓ Building confidence and motivation
- ✓ Goal setting and action planning
- ✓ Parent support and guidance
- ✓ Creating a personalised plan for your future



Book your **FREE** 15-minute Discovery Call

Let's have a relaxed conversation about where you are now and where you'd like to be.



Website: www.morethanpoints.ie



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You are enough.

YOU ARE DOING GREAT. KEEP BELIEVING IN YOU.

You have the power to shape your future.



Discover
Your Strengths



Explore
Your Options



Build
Your Roadmap



Step Into
Your Future



Angela's Final Message

“ For over twenty years, I've worked with young people who believed they weren't capable enough. Time and time again, I've watched those same young people flourish— not because they suddenly became more intelligent, but because they finally understood themselves.

Every learner has strengths. Every learner has potential. Sometimes all that's needed is someone to help uncover it.

If this guide has helped you see yourself differently, then it has already achieved its purpose.

I would be delighted to help you take the next step on your journey.

Remember... you are far more than your points. 

Angela O'Sullivan 

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DISCOVER. GROW. ACHIEVE. THRIVE.

Let's start your journey together 

I LOOK FORWARD TO HEARING FROM YOU.



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